



FREE Pizza
at Tuesday
meetings!

SMU Society of Physics Students



Kick-Off: Tuesday, September 1st at 6 PM

Heroy Room 153

Presentation by Darryl Berry

Faculty Advisor / Sponsor Heidi Wu

Graduate Advisor / Sponsor Darryl Berry

Faculty Support Fred Olness, Robert Kehoe

Staff Support William McCoy

Supplemental Slides from Earl Blodgett, Interim Director of SPS and Sigma
Pi Sigma and National SPS Organization

Agenda

- Upcoming Opportunities from Dr. Olness
- About the SPS
- Local SPS Leadership
- Upcoming Events
 - Telescopes
- SPS Jeopardy

Upcoming Opportunities, Dr. Olness

- **TACOS @ TAMU: October 23-24, 2026**

<https://sites.google.com/view/texas-tacos/upcoming-meetings?authuser=0>

Theoretical Astroparticle and Cosmology
Symposium in Texas

2026 Fall Meeting of the Texas, Arkansas, and Oklahoma Section of the American Physical Society

<https://www.aps.org/events/2026/fall-2026-joint-taoaps-texas>

Nov. 6–8, 2026

- **STREAM Day (Science, Technology, Reading, Engineering, Arts, and Math)**
- 9th Annual S.T.R.E.A.M. Day **Saturday, November 7th from 9:00am - 1:30pm.**
We would love for you to come back and kick off that day with your Physics Circus beginning at 9am. Please let me know if you are available.
- Southern Methodist University hosts an annual STREAM Day (Science, Technology, Reading, Engineering, Arts, and Math) organized by the Simmons School of Education & Human Development Upward Bound Math & Science programs
- Monday 7 December: Honors physics poster display & competition

About the SPS

Two Linked but Distinct Societies



SPS aims to support all undergrads in physics and astronomy and welcomes all with an interest in physics and astronomy. Founded in 1968



ΣΠΣ is the physics and astronomy honor society, housed within the Society of Physics Students and is the honors society of Physics and Astronomy. Founded in 1921



Governance of SPS and ΣΠΣ

SPS National Council

18 geographic regions

- 18 students, 1-year terms
- 18 faculty, 3-year terms

Executive Committee

- AIP CEO
- SPS President
- ΣΠΣ President
- Member-at-large, 3-year term
- Associate Zone Councilor (student)
- Director of SPS & ΣΠΣ
- Historian, 3-year term, ex officio

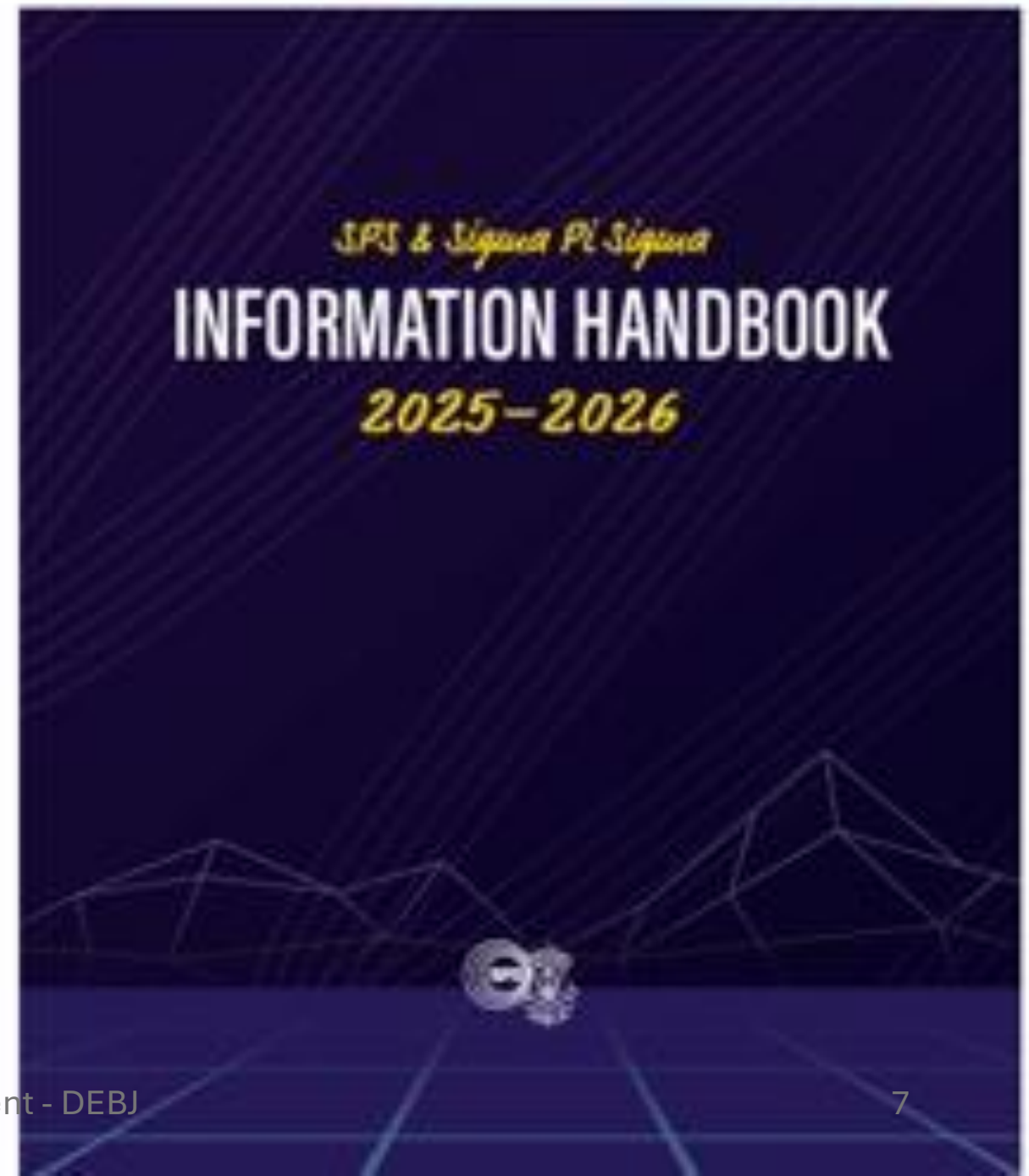


Your chapter gets to vote
every year for elections.

See the SPS 101 attachment

Everything you need to know

- This is your one stop shop about what SPS does. Details on:
 - Scholarships
 - Awards
 - Deadlines
 - Chapter health
 - Sigma Pi Sigma
 - Contact Information
 - Chapter charter days



SPS Membership Options

1. Individual Membership

- \$24 for a 1-year membership
- Ideal for individuals or members-at-large
- Instant!

2. Group Membership

- >5 sign up at once for up to 25% discount



3. Chapter Membership

PAID

- 200 person memberships for \$350 flat rate
- Only \$200 for Community Colleges

Email to be added to list

- deberry@smu.edu
- Put “SPS Mailing List” in the subject, I’ll also send the SPS Kickoff PPT and SPS 101
- Will see about official mailing list email

Local SPS Leadership

Email me your
interest:
deberry@smu.edu

YOU!!!

President?

Vice President?

Outreach/Visitation Coordinator?

Treasurer?

Secretary?

If there are multiple
for a role, we can
vote next meeting!

New Undergrad
Leadership can
change up things!!

- Faculty Advisor / Sponsor Heidi Wu
- Graduate Advisor / Sponsor Darryl Berry
- Faculty Support Robert Kehoe, Fred Olness
 - Staff Support William McCoy

Upcoming Events

New Undergrad
Leadership can
change these!!

Future Meetings: Every **First Wednesday**

Heroy Room 153 @ 6 PM

OCTOBER: Applying for Grad School in Physics by a Physics Grad Student

NOVEMBER: Popular Topics in Physics/Astronomy by a Physics Faculty/Professor

DECEMBER: Physics Clinic – Help with finals from physics grad students

Free pizza and drinks every meeting!!

Star Parties Monthly!!

Meeting at FOSC16 7 PM

In partnership with the Department of Physics and the Physics Graduate Student Association

SEPTEMBER on the 19th: Learn the Telescopes

OCTOBER AROUND the 20th: Moon Viewing

Summer 2027 Trip

- LIGO
- VLA
- MCDONALD OBSERVATORY

Some of Our Telescopes



NCG 2905



SPS Kick Off Event - DEBJ





M13

SPS Kick Off Event - DEBJ



SPS Jeopardy

PHYSICS & ASTRONOMY

JEOPARDY!

Created by:



SOCIETY OF PHYSICS
STUDENTS

Image Courtesy of NASA